

Food Safety and Hygiene Procedures

Kildare Craft Coffee Ltd | Version 3, March 2025 | Responsible person: Ciarán Doyle, café manager

1. Purpose

These procedures keep our customers safe and help us meet the requirements of the Food Safety Authority of Ireland (FSAI). Every member of staff must follow them. If you are unsure about anything, stop and ask the shift lead or the café manager. Never guess.

2. Personal hygiene

- Wash your hands with soap and warm water for at least 20 seconds: at the start of every shift, after breaks, after using the toilet, after handling raw food, waste or money, and after touching your face or hair.
- Cover cuts with a blue waterproof plaster.
- Staff who have had vomiting or diarrhoea must not work until they have been free of symptoms for 48 hours. Tell the café manager before your shift.

3. Temperature control

Fridges and freezers

Equipment	Safe temperature
Fridges and the display chiller	0°C to 5°C
Freezer	-18°C or colder

Check and record every fridge and freezer temperature on the temperature log three times a day: at opening, at 12:00 and at closing.

If a fridge reads above 5°C: check that the door is closed and re-check after 30 minutes. If it is still above 5°C, move the food to another fridge and tell the café manager. If high-risk food (milk, cream, cooked meats, filled sandwiches) has been above 8°C for more than 2 hours, it must be thrown away and recorded on the waste sheet.

Hot food

- Hot food on display must be kept at 63°C or above.
- Food that is reheated must reach a core temperature of at least 75°C, checked with the probe thermometer.
- Food can only be reheated once.

Probe thermometer

Clean the probe with an antibacterial wipe before and after every use. The probe is checked every month: it must read between -1°C and 1°C in iced water and between 99°C and 101°C in boiling water. If it fails either check, replace the batteries and test again; if it still fails, replace the probe.

4. Allergens

We follow the FSAI rules on the 14 allergens: celery, cereals containing gluten, crustaceans, eggs, fish, lupin, milk, molluscs, mustard, nuts, peanuts, sesame, soya and sulphites.

- The allergen matrix for every product we sell is in the red folder beside the till. Always check it; never guess or rely on memory.
- If a customer tells you about an allergy, tell the shift lead and use a clean jug and clean steam wand cloth for their drink.

- **Oat milk:** the oat milk we use is not certified gluten-free. Customers with coeliac disease should be offered soya milk or another certified gluten-free option instead.
- If we cannot be sure a product is safe for a customer's allergy, we must say so and not serve it.

5. Date labelling

Label every opened or prepared item with the product name, the date it was opened or made, and your initials.

Item	Use within
Opened dairy milk	3 days of opening
Opened oat or soya milk	5 days of opening
Cut cakes and traybakes	2 days
Home-made soup	2 days (chilled)
Sandwich fillings	2 days

Anything past its date is thrown away and recorded on the waste sheet.

6. Cleaning schedule

Frequency	Task
After every use	Purge and wipe steam wands; wipe the counter
Daily (at close)	Backflush the espresso machine; clean the grinder hoppers; mop floors; empty and clean the dishwasher
Weekly (Monday after close)	Deep clean of fridges, including door seals; clean the extraction hood filters
Monthly	Descale the kettle; check the probe thermometer
Every 3 months	Espresso machine service and descaling by Eireann Espresso Services (see the Equipment Guide)

Use the blue cloths for counters and the red cloths for toilets only.

7. Deliveries

Check chilled deliveries with the probe thermometer when they arrive. Chilled goods must be at 5°C or below. See the Purchasing and Supplier Policy for when to reject a delivery.

8. Pest control

If you see any sign of pests (droppings, gnawed packaging, insects), tell the café manager immediately and do not use any affected food. Our pest control contractor, PestAway Kildare, visits once a month. Their emergency number is 045 555 0142.

9. Records

Temperature logs, waste sheets and cleaning records are kept in the black folder in the office for 12 months. Environmental Health Officers may ask to see them at any time.